



Offline navigation for iOS!

Google Maps finally adds offline navigation capabilities to its iOS app
<http://dgit.in/GogIOffline>



Do Not Distrub

Slack adds DND mode to help overwhelmed team members.
<http://dgit.in/SlackDND>



Security in the world of IoT

We spoke to Santosh Pillai, an industry veteran with decades of experience in digital technology security vertical. He shares key insights about security and IoT, giving us plenty of food for thought. Excerpts from our interview follow:



◀ Santosh Pillai,
Director & CTO, 2020 Imaging

Mithun Mohandas
mitbun.mobandas@digit.in

1 Looking at the IoT landscape in its current form, it is quite evident that there is a lack of standardization in terms of security protocols. Every device manufacturer is coming up with own implementation. To offset costs, compromising on security seems to be an avenue since there is nobody to keep an eye out. Even the FCC only recently overhauled RF rules (<http://dgit.in/fccrf>) after 17 years. How long do you think it will be before a universal framework is established for all manufacturers?

Santosh: IT networks have been evolving over the last three decades and IoT networks will also go through an evolution cycle. The transition of IoT networks from closed network to enterprise network to public network has already started. However, the traditional networking standards will need to be adapted to the IoT requirements, especially when it comes to security. For example, device-based digital certifications from boot-up to handshakes to operations will greatly reduce the security threat in IoT networks. A seamless interface with enterprise firewall applications, for instance, will be a near-term essential. I think it will take another three to five years to setup IoT frameworks and security will be a major part in that.

2 Will the IoT bubble burst? If so when? The reason behind this question comes from a recent survey ([link](#)) which indicates that 50 per cent of the customers surveyed were skeptical about IoT devices due to security concerns and about 90 per cent of developers had similar concerns as well. If the customer pool seems undecided over a technology, why would developers focus their energy towards the same?

Santosh: The IoT bubble may burst in its current format, only to evolve into a more business centric framework. The IT revolution has successfully converted data into intelligence, now the IoT revolution is converting intelligence into actionable intelligence. Many customers that we are talking to, especially in the manufacturing sector have already started to execute IoT projects. Security concerns may continue to remain for a longer time than concerns on business use cases. However, it is only a matter of time before these concerns are trashed out, at least to get the ball rolling. The fact that Gartner continues to have IoT as a top technology trend, the fact that IT giants like Cisco continue to have IoT as a business focus, the fact that device leaders like Schneider Electric have IoT in the heart of their ecosystem, and the fact that IoT continues to reign a major proportion of technology start-ups across the world means the Internet of Things as a concept is here to stay.

3 How will Li-Fi impact the nascent IoT landscape?

Santosh: Wi-Fi does present a limitation in terms of number of devices and systems at the aggregation level, hence a faster Wi-Fi on a different technology as that of Li-Fi will positively impact the number of aggregation devices. However, the business use cases are more important right now for IoT's growth story, than the bandwidth limitations. Li-Fi will be needed when IoT transforms itself into IoE (Internet of Everything).

4 Other than the glaring security issues, what is the biggest obstacle along the road for IoTs?

Santosh: Creation of definitive use-cases that create business impact is the biggest obstacle right now for IoT. Once that happens, the other challenges like adoption and standardization will take care of themselves. But one suggestion that we have for IT leaders adopting IoT solutions for their enterprises is to follow a bi-modal approach where they continue to run their existing business on their current systems and switch over to an IoT framework for new business requirements. This way, they not only mitigate the risks of new technology but can also create validations for business leaders to sponsor more such initiatives in the future. **1**